

iOS 8

iOS 8 wasn't a huge upgrade over the previous versions in terms of innovations. Most of the changes were improvements on existing technologies and apps. There were quite a few improvements for developers that made it easier for them to accomplish a lot more. To begin with, we saw Handoff, a method of syncing work between multiple iDevices allowing you to commence work on one device, pause and resume from another device altogether. The iOS app sandboxing was made a little less stringent allowing apps to communicate with each other. So you could now use another app's features with your own app provided you incorporated their API. So there was no need to send a communications request to a remote server, you could do all of that within your device. Two new APIs were released under the HealthKit and HomeKit bucket allowing more apps to be built. HealthKit could be used to communicate between different personal health apps, and similarly, HomeKit did the same for home automation.

• iOS 9

Following in the footsteps of iOS 8, iOS 9 felt more like an incremental update as well. Things that stood out include App Slimming, a feature that ensure that only the assets required for your device would be stored locally. Let's say if you had an iPhone 6 and if an app had assets made for the iPad and previous iPhones, then those would not be downloaded to your iPhone, only the iPhone 6 specific assets would be. Siri's abilities got a shot in the arm and apparently so did the battery, but a more consumer friendly change was the introduction of content blocking extensions for Safari in iOS. This allowed users to block social media trackers, cookies etc.

• iOS 10

With iOS 10 came Widgets, yes, those widgets which have been present in Android since version 1.1. Also actions such as picking up your phone caused the iPhone to wake, this too was a me-too from Apple but nevertheless welcome. iOS 10 was also the first version to allow users to delete default apps from the system. Then there is the Voicemail transcription service which has been incorporated into the Phone app. Voicemails might not be widely used in India, but it's still a notable upgrade. Siri was opened up to third-party developers and Maps got a massive overhaul as well. And lastly, we don't need to say much about the camera app which introduced much bigger improvements to the Live Photos feature and the option of shooting in RAW.